

Installation woes

Installing Linux was a task and a half. In many, if not all cases, Linux users were automatically risking their Windows installation because at times installers made a mistake while calculating the partition layout (especially when trying to figure out where Windows was installed if it was a dual booting system with two copies of Windows installed on it). Sometimes, NTFS resize would fail and at other times, it was hard to figure out what 'ext2' and 'ext3' stood for. While ReiserFS helped to an extent, it didn't solve a number of other problems. To make matters worse, very few users actually knew what to fill in as the 'domain name' when Linux installers asked for it. As you can see, installation wasn't exactly a walk in the park so many failed and gave up during the setup itself.

If you got it up and running, well, bravo – you now had another new set of problems to tackle. Since the internet was not as resourceful as it is today, there was very little help and support available on the internet for the operating system. While forums like Digit's existed for this purpose, solving

```
*wvdial.conf (/etc) - gedit
File Edit View Search Tools Documents Help

[Dialer Defaults]
Init1 = ATZ
Init2 = ATQ0 V1 E1 S0=0 &C1 &D2 +FCLASS=0
Modem Type = USB Modem
ISDN = 0
New PPPD = yes
Modem = /dev/ttyACM0
Baud = 460800
; Phone = <Target Phone Number>
; Password = <Your Password>
; Username = <Your Login Name>

Plain Text Tab Width: 8 Ln 12, Col 31 INS
```

Remember the issues with plus signs, ampersands, idiot modes, usernames etc? Yes, the non-hotspotting era!